

THE LAST FIVE YEARS · THE SECOND SCREEN

# The Cue Bible

build-2026-09-14R · the composed stage

*143 cues · 14 songs · generated from the live show build, so this document cannot drift from what the phones actually do*

**THE STANDING RULE: the phone behaves exactly like a real phone.** Tapping a notification IS the unlock — the app opens directly, no home screen. Inboxes and message lists load whole the instant the app opens, and a full life continues past the bottom edge of the glass. Only what would genuinely arrive right now — a text, a notification, new mail — appears live, and new mail lands at the top. Anything that violates this is a bug, even if it would make a nice theatrical beat.

*How to read each entry: the header gives the cue ID, which screen, whose phone, the app, and the musical anchor. ON SCREEN is the complete content, verbatim and untruncated. PLAYS covers mechanics the engine performs on its own — navigation, self-timed animation, synthesized sound. PHONES gives the state after the cue when it changed. Gold notes carry dramaturgy, holds, and open director choices.*

# 1 · Still Hurting CATHY SINGS · 20 FIRES

COLD OPEN. Her phone is the first actor on stage. The house learns the grammar wordlessly: a notification is tapped and the app is simply there; a list is already full; only what would truly arrive live ever arrives live. When she puts the phone down, the memories go full-bleed — non-diegetic, the frame gone.

## 1.1 SR · CATHY · Lock screen — PROLOGUE — *the wedding waltz begins. SHE is discovered on her phone.*

Preshow card out. Her phone, lit, already in her hand. JUNE 2026, the morning after.

### ON SCREEN

**STAMP** → “JUNE 2026”

**LOCK CLOCK** — 9:41 · Friday, June 12, 2026

**WALLPAPER** — M24 — cast photo of JAMIE — she never changed it

### PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY’s screen

PHONES SR = Lock screen · stamp “JUNE 2026” · clock 9:41

## 1.2 SR · CATHY · Lock screen — Prologue, next phrase

FACEBOOK pushes a Memories notification. The algorithm has no idea.

### ON SCREEN

**NOTIFICATION — Facebook · Memories (now):** “You have memories with Jamie Wellerstein to look back on today”

### PLAYS

sound: receive ding

### SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

## 1.3 SR · CATHY · Facebook Memories — Prologue — *she gives in*

She taps it. Face ID, straight into ON THIS DAY — and the screen leans in close so the house reads every card.

### PLAYS

TAP THE NOTIFICATION — a beat on the banner, Face ID passes, and the app opens DIRECTLY onto Facebook Memories. One motion. No home screen. (No touch dot anywhere in the show — cut by direction; the screen’s own feedback carries every tap.)

### SOUND

tap thock

PHONES SR = Facebook Memories · stamp “JUNE 2026” · clock 9:41

## 1.4 SR · CATHY · Facebook Memories — Prologue — *the first memory*

2021 — five years ago today. The first summer.

### ON SCREEN

**MEMORY CARD** — 5 years ago · 2021 — Cathy Hiatt · June 12, 2021

**post:** “is it insane to be this happy after nine months”

**media:** M18 — first-date night walk

**reactions:** 👍 64

### PLAYS

the feed advances one full-screen card · sound: soft pop

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**1.5** SR · CATHY · Facebook Memories — *Prologue — the second*

2022 — the year of the couch and the second Christmas.

**ON SCREEN**

**MEMORY CARD** — 4 years ago · 2022 — Cathy Hiatt · June 12, 2022

**post:** “our apartment has a name now. it is called The Couch.”

**media:** M15 — the hideous couch

**reactions:** 👍 88

**PLAYS**

the feed advances one full-screen card · sound: soft pop

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**1.6** SR · CATHY · Facebook Memories — *Prologue — the third*

2023 — the proposal. Her scroll stalls halfway with the card half-revealed — a beat of not being ready — then commits.

**ON SCREEN**

**MEMORY CARD** — 3 years ago · 2023 — Cathy Hiatt · June 12, 2023

**post:** “he asked. I said yes before he finished 💍”

**media:** M3a — the ring, the rowboat

**reactions:** 👍 341

**PLAYS**

the feed advances one full-screen card · sound: soft pop

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**1.7** SR · CATHY · Facebook Memories — *Prologue rolls into the INTRO of Still Hurting*

2024 — the wedding portrait. Dragged into view slowly, thumb never leaving the glass.

**ON SCREEN**

**MEMORY CARD** — 2 years ago · 2024 — Cathy Wellerstein · June 12, 2024

**post:** “married three weeks and 800 miles apart. worth it.”

**media:** M4 — the wedding portrait

**reactions:** 👍 402

**PLAYS**

the feed advances one full-screen card · sound: soft pop

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**1.8** SR · CATHY · Facebook Memories — *Intro — the last card*

2025 — the pier. Her first flick fails and the feed snaps back — she is not ready for this one — a long beat, then she drags it over herself.

**ON SCREEN**

**MEMORY CARD** — 1 year ago · 2025 — Cathy Wellerstein · June 12, 2025

**post:** “look who made it to Ohio 🥰”

**media:** M1 — the pier, golden hour

**reactions:** 👍 47

**PLAYS**

the feed advances one full-screen card · sound: soft pop

**HOLD** · *Five years in five cards, all before she sings a word. Let this one sit.*

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**1.9** SR · CATHY — *FIRST BAR of Still Hurting*

She puts the phone down. The song is hers — screen to black.

**ON SCREEN**

**HOUSE BLACK** — the phone vanishes into it

**PLAYS**

hard black

**SOUND**

room tone out

### 1.10 SR · CATHY · Messages — *INTERLUDE, m. 58 — after “Like it’s simple, like it’s right.” She picks the phone back up.*

Unlock. Messages. Everyone already knows — the whole list is condolences.

#### ON SCREEN

##### MESSAGES LIST — loads whole, already full:

- Jamie — “You: please just call me” (Wednesday)
- Mom ❤️ • — “call me when you’re up. I love you.” (8:02 AM)
- Dana + girls 🍷 • — “Dana: we’re coming over at 7. non-negotiable.” (7:41 AM)
- Grammy • — “bubbeleh. are you eating?” (Yesterday)
- Beth — “just heard. I’m so so sorry ❤️” (Yesterday)
- Aunt Patti — “your mother told me. calling tonight” (Wednesday)
- Michael (voice) — “no lesson this week. take care of you.” (Tuesday)
- Ohio Housing — “Re: summer sublet – deposit received” (Monday)
- CVS Pharmacy — “Your prescription is ready for pickup” (Monday)
- Dentist – Dr. Okafor — “Reminder: cleaning Jun 22, 2:30 PM” (Sunday)

#### PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY’s screen

UNLOCK — the lock slides up and away → home screen · sound: unlock swish

OPENS Messages — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

no animation — the list is already full; the last rows cut off at the bottom of the glass

#### SOUND

unlock swish

PHONES SR = Messages · stamp “JUNE 2026” · clock 9:41

### 1.11 SR · CATHY · Messages — *Interlude — she opens his thread*

His name, then the thread — mid-history, cold logistics from May going colder, days of her asking, all Delivered, all silent. Close-up on the conversation.

#### ON SCREEN

##### THREAD HISTORY — loads whole with the thread:

– May 12 · 6:40 PM

**SENT (blue):** “your mail is piling up here”

**RECEIVED (gray):** “I’ll come by this week”

**SENT (blue):** “ok”

– May 30 · 9:12 PM

**SENT (blue):** “the super needs to know about the lease by the 15th”

– Monday · 11:02 PM

**SENT (blue):** “are you coming home this weekend?”

– Wednesday · 8:15 AM

**SENT (blue):** “please just call me”

– Wednesday · 9:30 PM

**SENT (blue):** “I still have your ring”

**status:** Delivered

#### PLAYS

HESITATION — “Jamie” holds the iOS pressed-gray under a resting finger ... and does not commit. Holds until the next cue.

TAP COMMITS — the pressed row releases and pushes through · sound: tap

thread pushes in from the list — Jamie

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**1.12** SR · CATHY · Messages — *Interlude — she types it live*

PRESENT — 9:41 this morning. Typed in real time, hesitant.

**ON SCREEN**

**thread caption:** Today · 9:41 AM

**TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed):** “I’m not sure that I can do this without you”

**PLAYS**

sound: key clicks

**SOUND**

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

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**1.13** SR · CATHY · Messages — *Interlude — SHE SENDS IT*

Send. Delivered.

**ON SCREEN**

**SEND** – the draft springs up into the thread as a blue bubble

**delivery status:** Delivered

**PLAYS**

sound: send swoosh

**SOUND**

send whoosh

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**1.14** SR · CATHY · Messages — *What about lies, Jamie?*

Delivered → READ, 9:44. He is awake. He is holding his phone.

**ON SCREEN**

**LOCK CLOCK** – 9:44

**STATUS FLIPS** → Read 9:44 AM

**HOLD** · *Let the receipt sit alone for a full phrase.*

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**1.15** SR · CATHY · Messages — *What about you, Jamie? — on the soft bloom*

His typing bubble rises. He is answering.

**ON SCREEN**

**typing indicator rises (three dots)**

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**1.16** SR · CATHY · Messages — *What about you?*

It stops. Nothing comes. He read it and put the phone down.

**ON SCREEN**

**typing indicator disappears**

**HOLD** · *The cruellest silence available in 2026.*

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**1.17** SR · CATHY — *She locks the phone*

She puts it down. Black.

**ON SCREEN**

**HOUSE BLACK** – the phone vanishes into it

**PLAYS**

hard black

**SOUND**

room tone out

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**1.18** SR · CATHY · Facebook Memories — “Give me a day, Jamie!” — *the memories return, full screen*

NON-DIEGETIC — she is not holding the phone. The frame drops away and the feed fills the whole screen, resting on the wedding.

**PLAYS**

the full shell appears — CATHY’s screen

cut to Facebook Memories (instant)

PHONES SR = Facebook Memories · stamp “JUNE 2026” · clock 9:44

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**1.19** SR · CATHY · Facebook Memories — “Bring back the lies” — *back to the beginning*

The feed drifts back to the first summer — the happiest card, enormous, to close the song.

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**1.20** SR · CATHY — *FINAL CUTOFF*

HARD BLACK on the cutoff.

**ON SCREEN**

**HOUSE BLACK** — the phone vanishes into it

**PLAYS**

hard black

**SOUND**

room tone out

## 2 · Shiksa Goddess **JAMIE SINGS · 11 FIRES**

THE FIRST NIGHT, FROM HIS SIDE. Three overwrought drafts die under the backspace key before two words survive: “home safe?” — the exact text the finale receives five years later. She answers by calling instead. His hesitation here is the measure for how fast he moves in 13.

### 2.1 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — *Segue chord out of her blackout*

His phone, September 2021, 11:38 PM. Locked. Walking home.

#### ON SCREEN

**STAMP** → “SEPTEMBER 2021”

**LOCK CLOCK** — 11:38 · Friday, September 3, 2021

#### PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

PHONES SL = Lock screen · stamp “SEPTEMBER 2021” · clock 11:38

### 2.2 SL · JAMIE · Messages — *I’m breaking my mother’s heart — THE SECOND TIME*

The phone comes out. Unlock, straight to Messages — her number sits on top, one hour old.

#### ON SCREEN

**MESSAGES LIST** — loads whole, already full:

- Cathy Hiatt ● — “it’s cathy 😊 — from tonight” (10:42 PM)
- Rob ● — “well??? how’d it go” (10:12 PM)
- Mom ❤️ ● — “dinner sunday. no excuses.” (8:05 PM)
- Linda Whitfield — “pages by Friday. I mean it.” (Yesterday)
- Elissa Weiss — “You: it was fun, but...” (Tuesday)
- H. Greenblatt — “ok. good luck with the book I guess” (Monday)
- S. Rosen — “You: I’ll call you this week” (2 wks ago)
- Columbia workshop — “Adam: notes attached for Thursday” (2 wks ago)

#### PLAYS

UNLOCK — the lock slides up and away → home screen · sound: unlock swish

OPENS Messages — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

no animation — the list is already full; the last rows cut off at the bottom of the glass

#### SOUND

unlock swish

PHONES SL = Messages · stamp “SEPTEMBER 2021” · clock 11:38

## 2.3 SL · JAMIE · Messages — Before “...my grandfather’s rolling in his grave” — the first draft

Her thread — one message in it: her number. He types a long, overwrought draft in full.

### ON SCREEN

**THREAD HISTORY — loads whole with the thread:**

— Today · 10:42 PM

**RECEIVED (gray):** “it’s cathy 😊 — from tonight”

**LOCK CLOCK — 11:39**

**TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed):** “Tonight was maybe the best night of my whole life”

### PLAYS

HESITATION — “Cathy Hiatt” holds the iOS pressed-gray under a resting finger ... and does not commit. Holds until the next cue.

TAP COMMITS — the pressed row releases and pushes through · sound: tap

thread pushes in from the list — Cathy Hiatt

sound: key clicks

### SOUND

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

## 2.4 SL · JAMIE · Messages — Still before the grandfather line — deleted; a bolder one

Backspaces every character, then tries again, bolder.

### ON SCREEN

**BACKSPACES the draft to nothing (fast rattle)**

**TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed):** “So when can I see you again. Tomorrow?”

### PLAYS

sound: backspace rattle

sound: key clicks

### SOUND

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

rapid delete clicks

## 2.5 SL · JAMIE · Messages — ...and that one goes too

Deleted. 11:41. Failing to write a text on a sidewalk.

### ON SCREEN

**BACKSPACES the draft to nothing (fast rattle)**

**LOCK CLOCK — 11:41**

### PLAYS

sound: backspace rattle

### SOUND

rapid delete clicks

## 2.6 SL · JAMIE — He pockets the phone

Black while he sings.

### ON SCREEN

**HOUSE BLACK — the phone vanishes into it**

### PLAYS

hard black

### SOUND

room tone out

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## 2.7 SL · JAMIE · Messages — “I’ve been standing for days with the phone in my hand” — it comes back out

The thread again. 11:47.

### ON SCREEN

**THREAD HISTORY** – loads whole with the thread:

– Today · 10:42 PM

**RECEIVED (gray):** “it’s cathy 😊 – from tonight”

**LOCK CLOCK** – 11:47

### PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

cut to Messages (instant)

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## 2.8 SL · JAMIE · Messages — “Like an idiot, scared to death” — he finally sends it

Two words: “home safe?” — typed and SENT. The finale receives this exact text at 11:58.

### ON SCREEN

**LOCK CLOCK** – 11:48

**thread caption:** · 11:48 PM

**TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed):** “home safe?”

**SEND** – the draft springs up into the thread as a blue bubble

**delivery status:** Delivered

### PLAYS

sound: key clicks

sound: send swoosh

### SOUND

send whoosh

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

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## 2.9 SL · JAMIE · Messages — Under the vamp

Her typing bubble appears — and stays up.

### ON SCREEN

**typing indicator rises (three dots)**

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## 2.10 SL · JAMIE · Phone — “And if you had a pierced tongue” — he is ON THE PHONE with Cathy

The bubble never resolves as a text — she called instead. Connected call, her name on his screen.

### ON SCREEN

**CALL SCREEN** – Cathy Hiatt · incoming call · incoming

**call state** → connected · 00:14

### SOUND

outgoing ring

PHONES SL = Phone · stamp “SEPTEMBER 2021” · clock 11:48

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## 2.11 SL · JAMIE — Call ends — phone away just before “breaking the circle”

Black, and it does not come back out. Nothing else until See I’m Smiling.

### ON SCREEN

**HOUSE BLACK** – the phone vanishes into it

### PLAYS

hard black

### SOUND

room tone out

### 3 · See I'm Smiling BOTH SING · 12 FIRES

NEARLY EMPTY, BY DESIGN. One post and its climbing likes are the whole birthday; the screens stay black while she sings. Then his 2021 calls cut in — the agency cold call, the callback, and Rob (an outgoing dial, per the script) — and the house learns the projections can time-travel.

#### 3.1 BOTH · CATHY · Facebook — *Scene change — her phone rolls back to July 19, 2025*

Ohio, her birthday. Facebook opens on the post she just made — the pier photo.

##### ON SCREEN

**STAMP** → "JULY 2025 · OHIO"

**LOCK CLOCK** — 6:12 · Saturday, July 19, 2025

**SOCIAL POST** — **Cathy Wellerstein (now)**: "look who made it to Ohio 🥰 best birthday present"

**media**: M1 — cast photo: the pier, golden hour

**reactions**: 👍 47

##### PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY's screen

UNLOCK — the lock slides up and away → home screen · sound: unlock swish

OPENS Facebook — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

sound: soft pop

##### SOUND

unlock swish

PHONES BOTH = Facebook · stamp "JULY 2025 · OHIO" · clock 6:12

#### 3.2 BOTH · CATHY · Facebook — *A beat later*

The likes climb.

##### ON SCREEN

**LIKE COUNTER SPINS** → 47

#### 3.3 BOTH · CATHY — *She puts the phone away*

Black — the screens stay out of the song until the calls.

##### ON SCREEN

**HOUSE BLACK** — the phone vanishes into it

##### PLAYS

hard black

##### SOUND

room tone out

#### 3.4 BOTH · JAMIE · Phone — *"And you're mine... We're doing fine." — JAMIE DIALS. Time snaps back.*

HIS phone, 2021 — a cold call to the agency, via Dr. Adler. She is not his agent yet, so the phone shows the business listing, not a contact. (Script fact: Whitfield is his literary agent at her own agency; Elise is the editor at Random House.)

##### ON SCREEN

**STAMP** → "SEPTEMBER 2021"

**LOCK CLOCK** — 2:41 · Tuesday, September 14, 2021

**CALL SCREEN** — Whitfield Literary Agency · calling... · outgoing

##### PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE's screen

##### SOUND

outgoing ring

PHONES BOTH = Phone · stamp "SEPTEMBER 2021" · clock 2:41

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**3.5 BOTH · JAMIE · Phone** — *On his “Hi — I’m calling for Miss Whitfield”*

It connects. The conversation runs.

**ON SCREEN**

**call state** → connected · 00:08

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**3.6 BOTH · JAMIE** — *Through “what’s your address” — he hangs up*

The phone goes; the timeline takes the stage and ROLLS HOME — 2021 spins forward to her July 2025, big and center.

**ON SCREEN**

**HOUSE BLACK** — the phone vanishes into it

**LOCK CLOCK** — 6:31 · Saturday, July 19, 2025

**STAMP** → “JULY 2025 · OHIO”

**PLAYS**

hard black

**SOUND**

room tone out

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**3.7 BOTH · JAMIE · Phone** — *“It’s all right — We’ll have tonight.” — the agency calls HIM back*

HIS phone again, 2021 — an INCOMING call from Miss Whitfield.

**ON SCREEN**

**STAMP** → “SEPTEMBER 2021”

**LOCK CLOCK** — 4:18 · Tuesday, September 14, 2021

**CALL SCREEN** — Whitfield Literary Agency · incoming call · incoming

**PLAYS**

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

**SOUND**

outgoing ring

PHONES BOTH = Phone · stamp “SEPTEMBER 2021” · clock 4:18

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**3.8 BOTH · JAMIE · Phone** — *“Hello... this is— oh, Miss Whitfield.” He answers*

Connected. It runs until the thank-you.

**ON SCREEN**

**call state** → connected · 00:21

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**3.9 BOTH · JAMIE** — *Through “thank you — this is great” — it ends*

Again: the call goes, the centered timeline rolls forward to her evening.

**ON SCREEN**

**HOUSE BLACK** — the phone vanishes into it

**LOCK CLOCK** — 6:47 · Saturday, July 19, 2025

**STAMP** → “JULY 2025 · OHIO”

**PLAYS**

hard black

**SOUND**

room tone out

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### 3.10 BOTH · JAMIE · Phone — *After Cathy’s “And not do anything at all” — JAMIE DIALS ROB*

SCRIPT: he dials — “perplexed but not unhappy.” The lease is up; an apartment WITH Cathy. 2021, pre-move-in — the era question answers itself.

#### ON SCREEN

**STAMP** → “SEPTEMBER 2021”

**LOCK CLOCK** — 8:02 · Tuesday, September 14, 2021

**CALL SCREEN** — Rob · calling mobile... · outgoing

#### PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

#### SOUND

outgoing ring

PHONES BOTH = Phone · stamp “SEPTEMBER 2021” · clock 8:02

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### 3.11 BOTH · JAMIE · Phone — *Rob picks up — “Yeah, listen. You know how my lease is up?”*

Connected — visible through the very end of the vamp.

#### ON SCREEN

**call state** → connected · 01:02

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### 3.12 BOTH · JAMIE — *DOWNBEAT of Moving Too Fast — he hangs up*

The Rob call goes; time rolls home to her July 2025 one last time, centered — song 4 will spin it back.

#### ON SCREEN

**HOUSE BLACK** — the phone vanishes into it

**LOCK CLOCK** — 7:04 · Saturday, July 19, 2025

**STAMP** → “JULY 2025 · OHIO”

#### PLAYS

hard black

#### SOUND

room tone out

## 4 · Moving Too Fast BOTH SING · 10 FIRES

THE AVALANCHE, COMPRESSED. Her one professional call, politely deflected — then his lock screen wins five times in the exact order he sings them: the apartment, the Atlantic, the money, Columbia, Sonny. The happy infrastructure of the marriage installs itself so the back half can dismantle it.

### 4.1 BOTH · JAMIE · Lock screen — *Count-off — drums in*

His phone, October 2021. Locked and quiet.

ON SCREEN

**STAMP** → “OCTOBER 2021”

**LOCK CLOCK** — 2:14 · Friday, October 8, 2021

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

PHONES BOTH = Lock screen · stamp “OCTOBER 2021” · clock 2:14

### 4.2 BOTH · CATHY · Phone — *“But oh, oh — what else am I s’posed to do?” — CATHY DIALS*

HER phone — MAY 2025, pinned by David (her backward line: between the pier and the party). Time ROLLS FORWARD from his October 2021 as she cuts in. Dialing Mike Stelmyer. Script fact: his agency is never named.

ON SCREEN

**LOCK CLOCK** — 10:10 · Friday, May 9, 2025

**STAMP** → “MAY 2025”

**CALL SCREEN** — Mike Stelmyer · calling... · outgoing

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY’s screen

SOUND

outgoing ring

PHONES BOTH = Phone · stamp “MAY 2025” · clock 10:10

### 4.3 BOTH · CATHY · Phone — *On her “Hello, this is Catherine Hiatt, I’m calling for Mike Stelmyer” — it connects*

We see the dial AND the connect.

ON SCREEN

**call state** → connected · 00:15

### 4.4 BOTH · JAMIE · Lock screen — *“I’ll call you soon!” — the call ends*

Back to HIS phone — time ROLLS BACK May 2025 → October 2021, locked, ready for the run of wins.

ON SCREEN

**LOCK CLOCK** — 2:14 · Friday, October 8, 2021

**STAMP** → “OCTOBER 2021”

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

PHONES BOTH = Lock screen · stamp “OCTOBER 2021” · clock 2:14

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**4.5 BOTH · JAMIE · Lock screen** — “*Found an apartment on Seventy-Third!*”

Move-in day pops up, both names on the day.

**ON SCREEN**

**NOTIFICATION** — **Calendar** · **MOVE-IN DAY** 📅 — **W 73rd St (now)**: “Saturday, Oct 16 · 9:00 AM · with Cathy Hiatt”

**PLAYS**

sound: receive ding

**SOUND**

notification tri-tone (soft)

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**4.6 BOTH · JAMIE · Lock screen** — “*The Atlantic Monthly’s printing my first chapter*”

The Atlantic says yes.

**ON SCREEN**

**NOTIFICATION** — **Mail** · **The Atlantic Monthly (now)**: “We are delighted to publish your excerpt”

**PLAYS**

sound: receive ding

**SOUND**

notification tri-tone (soft)

---

**4.7 BOTH · JAMIE · Lock screen** — “*Two thousand bucks without rewriting one word!*”

The deposit lands.

**ON SCREEN**

**NOTIFICATION** — **Chase (now)**: “You received a deposit of \$2,000.00”

**PLAYS**

sound: receive ding

**SOUND**

notification tri-tone (soft)

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**4.8 BOTH · JAMIE · Lock screen** — “*I left Columbia and don’t regret it*”

The withdrawal confirmation.

**ON SCREEN**

**NOTIFICATION** — **Mail** · **Columbia University (now)**: “Withdrawal processed – Fall term ✓”

**PLAYS**

sound: receive ding

**SOUND**

notification tri-tone (soft)

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**4.9 BOTH · JAMIE · Lock screen** — “*I wrote a book and Sonny Mehta read it!*”

THE BIGGEST HIT.

**ON SCREEN**

**NOTIFICATION** — **Messages** · **Linda Whitfield (now)**: “SONNY READ IT. CALL ME NOW.”

**PLAYS**

sound: receive ding

**SOUND**

notification tri-tone (soft)

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**4.10** BOTH · JAMIE — *Button*

Black.

**ON SCREEN**

**HOUSE BLACK** – the phone vanishes into it

**PLAYS**

hard black

**SOUND**

room tone out

## 5 · I'm a Part of That CATHY SINGS · 13 FIRES

HIS SILENCE, FROM HER SIDE. The party album has her as “and guest”; the repost crops her out; her texts sit Not Delivered under six hours of his Do Not Disturb. The 6:04 release — everything flips Delivered at once — is the quiet center of the song. Then a stranger’s photo of the dedication page.

### 5.1 SR · CATHY · Lock screen — *Intro figure*

Her phone, March 2025.

#### ON SCREEN

**STAMP** → “MARCH 2025”

**LOCK CLOCK** — 11:20 · Sunday, March 9, 2025

#### PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY’s screen

PHONES SR = Lock screen · stamp “MARCH 2025” · clock 11:20

### 5.2 SR · CATHY · Facebook — “One day we’re just like ‘Leave It to Beaver’”

She opens Facebook herself — and finds the party album. She is “and guest.”

#### ON SCREEN

**SOCIAL POST — Random House Events (now):** “Publication party! Tagged: Jamie Wellerstein and guest”

**media:** M7 — cast photo: party, Cathy at the frame’s edge

**reactions:** 👍 180

#### PLAYS

UNLOCK — the lock slides up and away → home screen · sound: unlock swish

OPENS Facebook — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

sound: soft pop

#### SOUND

unlock swish

PHONES SR = Facebook · stamp “MARCH 2025” · clock 11:20

### 5.3 SR · CATHY · Facebook — “And then he’s off on a trip to Jamie-land”

A fan account reposts it — cropped without her.

#### ON SCREEN

**SOCIAL POST — bookish\_nyc (now):** “the man of the hour ✨”

**media:** M7b — SAME PHOTO, RE-CROPPED — Cathy gone

**reactions:** 👍 322

#### PLAYS

sound: soft pop

### 5.4 SR · CATHY · Facebook — *And I’m a part of that.*

She comments on it anyway. Lovingly.

#### ON SCREEN

**COMMENT APPEARS** — Cathy: “❤️ so proud of this one”

### 5.5 SR · CATHY · Messages — “*Staring catatonic out the window*”

She opens his thread — yesterday’s ordinary warmth still sitting above, which makes today’s NOT DELIVERED colder.

#### ON SCREEN

**THREAD HISTORY** – loads whole with the thread:

– Tuesday · 8:12 AM

**RECEIVED (gray):** “gym then pages. love you”

**SENT (blue):** “bring back oat milk”

**RECEIVED (gray):** “👍”

– Thursday · 6:30 PM

**SENT (blue):** “callback went ok I think?? they laughed at the right spot”

**RECEIVED (gray):** “of course they did”

– Yesterday · 7:20 PM

**RECEIVED (gray):** “don’t wait up. this chapter is winning”

**SENT (blue):** “leftovers in the fridge. go get it, killer”

– Today · 12:04 PM

**SENT (blue):** “lunch?”

**status:** Not Delivered

#### PLAYS

OPENS Messages — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES SR = Messages · stamp “MARCH 2025” · clock 11:20

### 5.6 SR · CATHY · Messages — “*Barely even breathing all the while...*”

1:37. She tries again. Nothing.

#### ON SCREEN

**LOCK CLOCK** – 1:37

**thread caption:** · 1:37 PM

**TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed):** “ok eating without you”

#### PLAYS

sound: key clicks

#### SOUND

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

### 5.7 SR · CATHY · Messages — (*phrase button*)

Sent into the void. Not Delivered.

#### ON SCREEN

**SEND** – the draft springs up into the thread as a blue bubble

**delivery status:** Not Delivered

#### PLAYS

sound: send swoosh

#### SOUND

send whoosh

---

**5.8 SR · CATHY · Messages** — “*Next day it’s just like it never happened*”

3:15. Six hours of Do Not Disturb, from her side of it.

**ON SCREEN**

**LOCK CLOCK** – 3:15

**thread caption:** · 3:15 PM

**TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed):** “we’re out of coffee fyi”

**SEND** – the draft springs up into the thread as a blue bubble

**delivery status:** Not Delivered

**PLAYS**

sound: key clicks

sound: send swoosh

**SOUND**

send whoosh

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

---

**5.9 SR · CATHY · Messages** — “*And then he smiles*”

THE RELEASE — everything flips to Delivered at once. He woke up. (Clock: 6:04 PM.)

**ON SCREEN**

**LOCK CLOCK** – 6:04

**STATUS FLIPS** → Delivered ✓

**HOLD** · *The tightest band sync in the song. Land it on the smile.*

---

**5.10 SR · CATHY · Facebook** — *SHE opens the book and closes it.*

Back to Facebook — a reader has photographed the dedication page.

**ON SCREEN**

**SOCIAL POST – a reader (now):** “That dedication page though 🙄”

**media:** M12 – the dedication page: “For Cathy”

**reactions:** 👍 41

**PLAYS**

OPENS Facebook — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

sound: soft pop

PHONES SR = Facebook · stamp “MARCH 2025” · clock 6:04

---

**5.11 SR · CATHY · Facebook** — *(two bars later)*

Likes climb.

**ON SCREEN**

**LIKE COUNTER SPINS** → 41

---

**5.12 SR · CATHY · Search** — “*I’m a part of that... Aren’t I?*”

In the clear — she leaves Facebook, opens Safari, and types it into Google. The loneliest cue in the show.

**ON SCREEN**

**SEARCH BAR – types live:** “is it normal to feel invisible at your husband’s party”

**PLAYS**

OPENS Safari — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES SR = Search · stamp “MARCH 2025” · clock 6:04

---

**5.13** SR · CATHY · Search — *As the song ends*

She clears it.

ON SCREEN

search BACKSPACED clear

## 6 · The Schmuel Song **JAMIE SINGS · 2 FIRES**

STILLNESS, BY DIRECTION. One held Christmas image. No animation, no cueing inside the number — the kindest screen of the night, deliberately so; the generosity buys the betrayal its full price later. Not one Elise pixel anywhere in this song.

### 6.1 **SL · JAMIE · Lock screen** — *Christmas — the story is his to tell*

No animations, by direction: the phone just keeps the season. Lock screen, Christmas wallpaper (photo TBD — M23), December 2022.

#### ON SCREEN

**STAMP** → “DECEMBER 2022”

**LOCK CLOCK** — 9:12 · Saturday, December 24, 2022

**WALLPAPER** — M23 — Christmas tree lights

#### PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

PHONES **SL** = Lock screen · stamp “DECEMBER 2022” · clock 9:12

### 6.2 **SL · JAMIE** — *Cutoff*

Black.

#### ON SCREEN

**HOUSE BLACK** — the phone vanishes into it

#### PLAYS

hard black

#### SOUND

room tone out

## 7 · A Summer in Ohio CATHY SINGS · 4 FIRES

ONE CUE. The prerecorded FaceTime (V2) carries the entire number — Jamie at his desk, half-attending, writing, while Ohio sings to him. The engine draws only the FaceTime frame and the call chrome; everything alive in it is the video.

### 7.1 SR · CATHY · FaceTime — TOP OF THE SONG — intro vamp (anchor adjustable, Alonzo)

Cathy's laptop, June 2024, Ohio. She places the FaceTime call — the RINGING screen: his initial pulsing, "FaceTime...", no video yet.

#### ON SCREEN

**LOCK CLOCK** — 9:38 · Friday, June 21, 2024

**STAMP** → "JUNE 2024 · OHIO"

**FACETIME** — Jamie · FaceTime...

#### PLAYS

the MacBook shell appears — CATHY's screen

#### SOUND

FaceTime trill, then connect pop

PHONES SR = FaceTime · stamp "JUNE 2024 · OHIO" · clock 9:38

### 7.2 SR · CATHY · FaceTime — A few bars in — where he should appear (anchor adjustable, Alonzo)

He answers. The prerecorded FaceTime (V2) plays for the entire number — only Jamie, no Cathy self-view — with the real FaceTime overlays and a ticking call duration. Video produced separately.

#### ON SCREEN

**FaceTime state** → connected

**HOLD** · Nothing else to fire until the final button. The video carries the number.

### 7.3 SR · CATHY · FaceTime — FINAL BUTTON of the song

The call ends — Call Ended card, his initial dimmed. The whole song was one call.

#### ON SCREEN

**FaceTime state** → Call Ended

### 7.4 SR · CATHY — She closes the laptop

The screen goes; the era holds center until the next song rolls it.

#### ON SCREEN

**HOUSE BLACK** — the phone vanishes into it

#### PLAYS

hard black

#### SOUND

room tone out

## 8 · The Next Ten Minutes BOTH SING · 4 FIRES

TIME, NOT CONTENT. The phones mark only where we are: June 12, 2023 — then the one date both timelines share, enormous: MAY 18, 2024 — then back again on the rowboat line. The era rail does the traveling; the people do the vows.

**8.1** BOTH · CATHY · Lock screen — “No, that one’s Jerry Seinfeld... No, the Dakota —” · the rowboat, the question  
No animations, by direction: the phones only mark WHERE WE ARE IN TIME. The rowboat on the Central Park lake — “No, the Dakota” — pointing at the Upper West Side. The engagement day.

**ON SCREEN**

**STAMP** → “JUNE 12, 2023”

**LOCK CLOCK** — 4:44 · Monday, June 12, 2023

**PLAYS**

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY’s screen

PHONES BOTH = Lock screen · stamp “JUNE 12, 2023” · clock 4:44

**8.2** BOTH · CATHY · Lock screen — AT THE VOWS — the underscore turns

The only date both timelines will ever share, enormous.

**ON SCREEN**

**STAMP** → “MAY 18, 2024 · THE WEDDING”

**LOCK CLOCK** — 6:47 · Saturday, May 18, 2024

PHONES BOTH = Lock screen · stamp “MAY 18, 2024 · THE WEDDING” · clock 6:47

**8.3** BOTH · CATHY · Lock screen — CATHY’s “Is that one John Lennon?” — back in time to the engagement

The clock rolls back to the beginning of the piece.

**ON SCREEN**

**STAMP** → “JUNE 12, 2023”

**LOCK CLOCK** — 4:44 · Monday, June 12, 2023

PHONES BOTH = Lock screen · stamp “JUNE 12, 2023” · clock 4:44

**8.4** BOTH · CATHY — Cutoff

Black.

**ON SCREEN**

**HOUSE BLACK** — the phone vanishes into it

**PLAYS**

hard black

**SOUND**

room tone out

## 9 · A Miracle Would Happen JAMIE SINGS · 7 FIRES

NOTIFICATIONS ONLY. His married year arrives as a stack he never touches — readers, the growing book, Elise, front row. The phone will not stop, and he never once interacts with it. The attention just lands.

### 9.1 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — Vamp — his phone, locked

October 2024. Married, at a party, and the phone will not stop. He never touches it — the attention just arrives.

#### ON SCREEN

**STAMP** → “OCTOBER 2024”

**LOCK CLOCK** — 11:22 · Friday, October 18, 2024

#### PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

PHONES SL = Lock screen · stamp “OCTOBER 2024” · clock 11:22

### 9.2 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — “Every other woman in the world suddenly finds you attractive”

A reader.

#### ON SCREEN

**NOTIFICATION** — Instagram · @a.reader.somewhere (now): “okay the ending WRECKED me. how are you real”

#### PLAYS

sound: receive ding

#### SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

### 9.3 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — “And now they’re banging down your door”

And another.

#### ON SCREEN

**NOTIFICATION** — Instagram · @lit.with.lena (now): “sent you a message request”

#### PLAYS

sound: receive ding

#### SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

### 9.4 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — “I’m at these parties... I’m the grand fromage”

The book keeps growing without him.

#### ON SCREEN

**NOTIFICATION** — Goodreads (now): “Your book passed 10,000 ratings · ★ 4.6”

#### PLAYS

sound: receive ding

#### SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

### 9.5 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — “And here she comes: ‘Let’s get a cup of coffee...’” — Elise

And Elise.

#### ON SCREEN

**NOTIFICATION** — Messages · Elise · Ed. (now): “proofs went out 🥳 celebratory drink sometime?”

#### PLAYS

sound: receive ding

#### SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

---

**9.6** SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — “*It’s a challenge to resist temptation*”

Front row.

**ON SCREEN**

**NOTIFICATION** – Instagram · @novel.annie (now): “front row at your reading tonight 📖”

**PLAYS**

sound: receive ding

**SOUND**

notification tri-tone (soft)

---

**9.7** SL · JAMIE — *Button*

Black.

**ON SCREEN**

**HOUSE BLACK** – the phone vanishes into it

**PLAYS**

hard black

**SOUND**

room tone out

## 10 · Climbing Uphill CATHY SINGS · 13 FIRES

HER INTERIOR VS. HIS SCROLL. The bell-tone fragments rhyme with the sung monologue and never transcribe it — protect that rule in every edit.

### 10.1 SR · CATHY · Mail – reading — Intro

Her phone, February 2024, 6:02 AM. Audition day starts in Mail — the breakdown, opened and read.

#### ON SCREEN

**STAMP** → “FEBRUARY 2024”

**LOCK CLOCK** – 6:02 · Monday, February 5, 2024

**INBOX** – loads whole, the instant the app opens:

- Casting Networks • – BREAKDOWN – new musical (Equity) – F, 20s. Legit soprano to high C... (5:12 AM)
- Casting Office – Thank you for auditioning – We enjoyed meeting you. At this time... (Thursday)
- Backstage – 9 new roles match your profile – Apply today (Wednesday)
- Mom – Fwd: saw this and thought of you (Tuesday)
- Chase – Your statement is ready (Monday)

**THE EMAIL, OPENED** – Casting Networks → Cathy Hiatt-Wellerstein · “BREAKDOWN – new musical (Equity)” · 5:12 AM

SEEKING: F, 20s–30s.

Legit soprano to high C. Strong dancer.

MUST READ YOUNG.

Submit headshot & résumé. Sign-in opens 6:30 AM.

#### PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY’s screen

cut to Mail (instant)

no animation — a real inbox does not populate; it is simply THERE, continuing past the bottom edge

HESITATION — “Casting Networks” holds the iOS pressed-gray under a resting finger ... and does not commit. Holds until the next cue.

the row presses through — the email pushes in over the inbox

PHONES SR = Mail – reading · stamp “FEBRUARY 2024” · clock 6:02

### 10.2 SR · CATHY · Mail – reading — “I’m climbin’ uphill, Daddy”

The check-in text lands over the breakdown: she is number two hundred.

#### ON SCREEN

**NOTIFICATION – Messages · Audition Check-In (now):** “You’re checked in: #200 of 200. Estimated wait: 3 hr 40 min.”

#### PLAYS

sound: receive ding

#### SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

---

**10.3** SR · CATHY · Mail – reading — *(phrase button)*

The bank tells her what the headshots cost. Another banner, worse.

**ON SCREEN**

**NOTIFICATION – Chase (now):** “Declined: \$175.00 – REPRO-HEADSHOTS NYC. Available balance: \$23.41.”

**PLAYS**

sound: receive ding

**SOUND**

notification tri-tone (soft)

---

**10.4** SR · CATHY · Search — *FIRST BELL TONE*

Her head, typed into Google and never searched. Never a caption of what she sings.

**ON SCREEN**

**SEARCH BAR – types live:** “smile. breathe. don’t look at your shoes.”

**PLAYS**

OPENS Safari — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES SR = Search · stamp “FEBRUARY 2024” · clock 6:02

**HOLD** · *Bells are the tightest MD sync in the show. One fragment per bell.*

---

**10.5** SR · CATHY · Search — *Second bell*

“196 to go.”

**ON SCREEN**

**SEARCH BAR – types live:** “196 to go”

---

**10.6** SR · CATHY · Search — *Third bell*

“quiet till 6, he’s writing.”

**ON SCREEN**

**SEARCH BAR – types live:** “quiet till 6, he’s writing”

---

**10.7** SR · CATHY · Search — *Fourth bell*

“he didn’t ask about the callback.”

**ON SCREEN**

**SEARCH BAR – types live:** “he didn’t ask about the callback”

---

**10.8** SR · CATHY · Search — *Fifth bell*

“what am I doing here.”

**ON SCREEN**

**SEARCH BAR – types live:** “what am I doing here”

---

---

**10.9** SR · CATHY · Facebook — *(his interruption section)*

She closes Safari and scrolls HIS press instead. The review, going viral.

**ON SCREEN**

**SOCIAL POST — BOOKS Weekly (now):** “THE WELLERSTEIN MOMENT — the year’s most talked-about debut”

**reactions:** 👍 4212

**PLAYS**

OPENS Facebook — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

sound: soft pop

PHONES SR = Facebook · stamp “FEBRUARY 2024” · clock 6:02

---

**10.10** SR · CATHY · Facebook — *(with the build)*

4,212 and climbing, while she waits in a hallway.

**ON SCREEN**

**LIKE COUNTER SPINS** → 4212

---

**10.11** SR · CATHY · Facebook — *(call section)*

SEED FIVE — the party photo. A figure half in frame, never named.

**ON SCREEN**

**SOCIAL POST — Random House · tagged (now):** “celebrating the review!!”

**media:** M8 — cast photo: bar celebration · a figure half in frame

**reactions:** 👍 64

**PLAYS**

sound: soft pop

---

**10.12** SR · CATHY · Search — *AFTER THE LAST BELL — in the clear*

Back to Safari. Her search bar.

**ON SCREEN**

**SEARCH BAR — types live:** “how to quit acting gracefully”

**PLAYS**

OPENS Safari — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES SR = Search · stamp “FEBRUARY 2024” · clock 6:02

---

**10.13** SR · CATHY · Search — *As the final vamp dies*

Cleared.

**ON SCREEN**

**search BACKSPACED clear**

## 11 · If I Didn't Believe In You JAMIE SINGS · 10 FIRES

THE FIGHT HAS AN AUDIENCE: HIS PHONE. What the argument is actually about sits unsigned on the other side of the stage all song.

### 11.1 SL · JAMIE · calevent — *The fight is already underway.*

His phone, March 2026. The party invite on the real Calendar — his ✓ and her ✗ on the same screen.

#### ON SCREEN

**STAMP** → "MARCH 2026"

**LOCK CLOCK** — 7:41 · Friday, March 6, 2026

**CALENDAR EVENT** — "Publication Party — Book 2 🎉" · Tonight · 7:30 PM · 1745 Broadway

**invitees:** Jamie Wellerstein ✓ · Cathy Hiatt-Wellerstein ✗

#### PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE's screen

cut to calevent (instant)

PHONES SL = calevent · stamp "MARCH 2026" · clock 7:41

### 11.2 SL · JAMIE · Messages — *If I didn't believe in you,*

Elise texts, mid-argument — he opens the thread, and it visibly has a past.

#### ON SCREEN

**THREAD HISTORY** — loads whole with the thread:

— Feb 2025 · 1:14 AM

**RECEIVED (gray):** "still up? this chapter is killing me 😊"

**SENT (blue):** "for you I'm always up"

— Today · 7:41 PM

**RECEIVED (gray):** "are you coming or not?"

#### PLAYS

OPENS Messages — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES SL = Messages · stamp "MARCH 2026" · clock 7:41

### 11.3 SL · JAMIE · Messages — *We wouldn't be having this fight.*

She double-texts.

#### ON SCREEN

**RECEIVED BUBBLE (gray):** "people are asking where you are."

### 11.4 SL · JAMIE · Messages — *If I didn't believe in you —*

"fine." The deadliest text in the show.

#### ON SCREEN

**RECEIVED BUBBLE (gray):** "fine."

**HOLD** · *Phrase button, then let it sit in silence.*

---

**11.5** SL · JAMIE · Messages — “I’d walk out the door and say, ‘Cathy, you’re right’”

He types a reply.

**ON SCREEN**

**TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed):** “leaving in 10”

**PLAYS**

sound: key clicks

**SOUND**

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

---

**11.6** SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — [CHOICE — ALONZO] send it, or pocket it

He does NOT send. Phone in pocket, screen locked. Two very different Jamies.

**ON SCREEN**

**LOCK CLOCK — 9:12**

**PLAYS**

cut to Lock screen (instant)

PHONES SL = Lock screen · stamp “MARCH 2026” · clock 9:12

**HOLD** · *Decide in tech.*

---

**11.7** SL · JAMIE · Facebook — *THE PEAK of the bridge*

A memory resurfaces on his own phone: his own words, three years ago.

**ON SCREEN**

**SOCIAL POST — Memories (now):** ““EVERYONE go see my brilliant wife tonight. Front row forever.””

**reactions:** 👍 131

**PLAYS**

UNLOCK — the lock slides up and away → home screen · sound: unlock swish

OPENS Facebook — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

sound: soft pop

**SOUND**

unlock swish

PHONES SL = Facebook · stamp “MARCH 2026” · clock 9:12

**HOLD** · *The word “believe” curdles in real time.*

---

**11.8** SL · JAMIE · Facebook — *(two bars later)*

Likes climb on the corpse of it.

**ON SCREEN**

**LIKE COUNTER SPINS** → 131

---

**11.9** SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — *ON THE BLACKOUT*

A notification he will not see until morning; she signed the Ohio contract.

**ON SCREEN**

**LOCK CLOCK** – 11:47

**NOTIFICATION** – Mail · Summer Season (Ohio) (11:47 PM): “Contract received – C. Hiatt ✓”

**PLAYS**

cut to Lock screen (instant)

sound: receive ding

**SOUND**

notification tri-tone (soft)

PHONES SL = Lock screen · stamp “MARCH 2026” · clock 11:47

**HOLD** · *She made the decision while he was arguing.*

---

**11.10** SL · JAMIE — *Final cutoff*

Black.

**ON SCREEN**

**HOUSE BLACK** – the phone vanishes into it

**PLAYS**

hard black

**SOUND**

room tone out

## 12 · I Can Do Better Than That CATHY SINGS · 11 FIRES

HER GHOST REGISTER, USED FOR LOVE. Drafted courage, kept receipts, a shared playlist — the exact mirror of what his register becomes.

### 12.1 SR · CATHY · maps — *Vamp — the drive*

Her phone, November 2021. Real turn-by-turn: three hours forty to the Eastern Shore.

#### ON SCREEN

**STAMP** → “NOVEMBER 2021”

**LOCK CLOCK** — 4:05 · Saturday, November 6, 2021

**MAPS NAVIGATION** — Merge onto NJ Tpke S · via I-95 S

**ETA card**: 3 hr 40 min → Eastern Shore, MD

#### PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY’s screen

cut to maps (instant)

PHONES SR = maps · stamp “NOVEMBER 2021” · clock 4:05

### 12.2 SR · CATHY · music — *“My best friend had a little situation at the end of our senior year”*

She switches to Music — the collaborative playlist, real screen. He has already added three songs. The finale leaves it.

#### ON SCREEN

**MUSIC** — **playlist** “US 🎧” · Collaborative Playlist — Jamie & Cathy

♪ (greeked track) — Added by Jamie ✨

♪ (greeked track) — Added by Jamie ✨

♪ (greeked track) — Added by Jamie ✨

♪ (greeked track) — Added by you

#### PLAYS

OPENS Music — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES SR = music · stamp “NOVEMBER 2021” · clock 4:05

### 12.3 SR · CATHY · Facebook — *“And like a shot, she and Mitchell got married that summer”*

She opens Facebook — Carolann’s settled life, scrolling past.

#### ON SCREEN

**SOCIAL POST** — **Carolann (now)**: “MR & MRS MITCHELL 📖”

**media**: M11a — hometown wedding

**reactions**: 👍 74

#### PLAYS

OPENS Facebook — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

sound: soft pop

PHONES SR = Facebook · stamp “NOVEMBER 2021” · clock 4:05

### 12.4 SR · CATHY · Facebook — *“Carolann getting bigger ev’ry minute”*

The baby.

#### ON SCREEN

**SOCIAL POST** — **Carolann (now)**: “he’s here ❤️”

**media**: M11b — baby announcement

**reactions**: 👍 118

#### PLAYS

sound: soft pop

---

**12.5** SR · CATHY · Facebook — “They got a little cute house... with a crucifix on the door”

The house, crucifix on the door.

**ON SCREEN**

**SOCIAL POST – Carolann (now):** “our first HOUSE 🏠”

**media:** M11c – first house

**reactions:** 👍 203

**PLAYS**

sound: soft pop

---

**12.6** SR · CATHY · shot — (*the ex verse*)

She opens Photos — she kept the receipt: a screenshot saved a year ago, caption and all.

**ON SCREEN**

**PHOTOS – a saved screenshot, opened:** Screenshots · Saved Nov 2020

**inside the screenshot (gray bubble):** “I think I need to focus on my career right now. You’re great. – R”

**caption:** her caption: “a heartfelt letter, apparently”

**PLAYS**

OPENS Photos — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES SR = shot · stamp “NOVEMBER 2021” · clock 4:05

---

**12.7** SR · CATHY · Messages — *THE DRAFTS – pre-chorus*

She opens his thread — two months deep — then three weeks of drafted courage begin. Draft one, October 12.

**ON SCREEN**

**THREAD HISTORY – loads whole with the thread:**

– Oct 3 · 9:20 PM

**RECEIVED (gray):** “one month anniversary of “home safe?””

**SENT (blue):** “you kept the date??”

**RECEIVED (gray):** “I keep everything”

– Thursday · 11:02 PM

**SENT (blue):** “my radiator died again 🤖”

**RECEIVED (gray):** “MY radiator works fine. just saying”

**thread caption:** · DRAFTS · NEVER SENT

**TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed):** “so my lease is up in...”

**PLAYS**

OPENS Messages — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

sound: key clicks

**SOUND**

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

PHONES SR = Messages · stamp “NOVEMBER 2021” · clock 4:05

---

**12.8** SR · CATHY · Messages — *(next phrase)*

Draft two, two weeks later. Braver.

**ON SCREEN**

**BACKSPACES** the draft to nothing (fast rattle)

**caption:** OCT 12 · deleted

**TYPES LIVE** (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed): “how attached are you to your apartment”

**PLAYS**

sound: backspace rattle

sound: key clicks

**SOUND**

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

rapid delete clicks

---

**12.9** SR · CATHY · Messages — *(last phrase before the chorus)*

Draft three. All caps. Still not sent.

**ON SCREEN**

**BACKSPACES** the draft to nothing (fast rattle)

**caption:** OCT 26 · deleted

**TYPES LIVE** (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed): “MOVE IN WITH ME (too much?)”

**PLAYS**

sound: backspace rattle

sound: key clicks

**SOUND**

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

rapid delete clicks

**HOLD** · *Her ghosts are made of courage. His are made of cowardice.*

---

**12.10** SR · CATHY · Messages — “Say you’ll move in with me” — *deleted; she asks him out loud*

Deleted. She puts the phone down and asks him out loud instead.

**ON SCREEN**

**BACKSPACES** the draft to nothing (fast rattle)

**caption:** NOV 2 · deleted – she asks out loud instead

**PLAYS**

sound: backspace rattle

**SOUND**

rapid delete clicks

---

**12.11** SR · CATHY · maps — *(final chorus)*

Back to Maps. Twelve minutes out — the nav says arriving; so does she.

**ON SCREEN**

**MAPS NAVIGATION** – Continue straight · MD-33 W

**ETA card:** 12 min → Eastern Shore, MD · ARRIVING (green)

**PLAYS**

OPENS Maps — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES SR = maps · stamp “NOVEMBER 2021” · clock 4:05

## 13 · Nobody Needs to Know JAMIE SINGS · 14 FIRES

THE PAYOFF. The same three gestures as the first night, frozen over. Speed that read as charm now reads as practice.

### 13.1 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — *Intro, bar 1*

His phone lights the dark. June 2026, 6:12 AM. Not his bed.

#### ON SCREEN

**STAMP** → “JUNE 2026 · BEFORE DAWN”

**LOCK CLOCK** — 6:12 · Friday, June 12, 2026

#### PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

PHONES SL = Lock screen · stamp “JUNE 2026 · BEFORE DAWN” · clock 6:12

### 13.2 SL · JAMIE · Messages — *Bar 2*

Unlocked before the house has settled. Straight to Messages. No hesitation — that is the point.

#### PLAYS

UNLOCK — the lock slides up and away → home screen · sound: unlock swish

OPENS Messages — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

cut to Messages (instant)

#### SOUND

unlock swish

PHONES SL = Messages · stamp “JUNE 2026 · BEFORE DAWN” · clock 6:12

**HOLD** · *Her opening took four cues of hesitation. His takes one.*

### 13.3 SL · JAMIE · Messages — “I’m off to Ohio” — *the scroll-back*

THE SCROLL-BACK. Five years of seeded messages, in order, uncaptioned.

#### ON SCREEN

**THREAD HISTORY** — loads whole with the thread:

— May 2024 ·

**RECEIVED (gray)**: “ch. 7 notes attached – coffee thursday?”

**RECEIVED (gray)** — **PHOTO BUBBLE**: ch7-notes-v2.pdf · 214 KB

— Feb 2025 · 1:14 AM ·

**RECEIVED (gray)**: “still up? this chapter is killing me 😊”

**SENT (blue)**: “for you I’m always up”

— April 2026 ·

**RECEIVED (gray)**: “this stays at the office. agreed?”

**SENT (blue)**: “agreed.”

— Today · 6:04 AM

**SENT (blue)**: “I keep thinking about it”

**RECEIVED (gray)**: “don’t. not over text.”

**HOLD** · *Fire early and let it run. Recognition is the effect — do not explain it.*

**13.4** SL · JAMIE · Messages — “Hold on, facts are facts”

The real dialog, over the real thread: Delete this conversation? His thumb sits on Delete. Never presses.

**ON SCREEN**

**ACTION SHEET** slides up over the app – “Delete this conversation? This conversation will be deleted from all your devices.”

**buttons:** [Delete] (red) · [Cancel]

**FINGER RESTS ON** [Delete] – the button holds its pressed shade. Not pressing.

**HOLD** · *He keeps the thread. That is the corner he asks the house for.*

**13.5** SL · JAMIE · contact — Nobody needs to know.

Her contact card, mid-edit. ELISE · ED. struck through; R.H. EDITS typed in its place.

**ON SCREEN**

**CONTACT CARD** – R.H. EDITS · Random House

**name mid-edit:** “Elise · Ed.” struck through → “R.H. EDITS” typed in

PHONES SL = contact · stamp “JUNE 2026 · BEFORE DAWN” · clock 6:12

**13.6** SL · JAMIE · findmy — (next phrase)

He opens Find My. The confirmation asks if he is sure. He is. “Forever,” from Moving Too Fast, ends on a real button.

**ON SCREEN**

**FIND MY – People:** Cathy 📍: W 73rd St · now – sharing Until: Forever

**ACTION SHEET** slides up over the app – “Stop sharing your location with Cathy?”

**buttons:** [Stop Sharing] (red) · [Cancel]

**FINGER RESTS ON** [Stop Sharing] – the button holds its pressed shade. Not pressing.

**PRESSES** [Stop Sharing]

**FIND MY – People:** Cathy 📍: You stopped sharing your location

**PLAYS**

**OPENS** FindMy — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES SL = findmy · stamp “JUNE 2026 · BEFORE DAWN” · clock 6:12

**13.7** SL · JAMIE · calevent — THE BRIDGE

He opens Calendar — her opening night, three weeks out — ✓ Accepted, by him, in a life he is dismantling.

**ON SCREEN**

**CALENDAR EVENT** – “CATHY – OPENING NIGHT 🎭” · Friday, July 3 · 8:00 PM · in 3 weeks · Medina Summer Theatre, OH

**response bar:** ✓ Accepted (green)

**PLAYS**

**OPENS** Calendar — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES SL = calevent · stamp “JUNE 2026 · BEFORE DAWN” · clock 6:12

**HOLD** · *The only time all song the marriage speaks — and it is a calendar invite.*

---

**13.8** SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — *(verse 3)*

Back to HIM, 7:58. Her good-morning text arrives.

**ON SCREEN**

**LOCK CLOCK** – 7:58

**NOTIFICATION** – Messages · Cathy 🍷 (now): “morning! call me before rehearsal? miss your face”

**PLAYS**

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

cut to Lock screen (instant)

sound: receive ding

**SOUND**

notification tri-tone (soft)

PHONES SL = Lock screen · stamp “JUNE 2026 · BEFORE DAWN” · clock 7:58

---

**13.9** SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — *ON HIS SWIPE*

Gone. Unread.

**ON SCREEN**

**notification SWIPED AWAY** – slides off and is gone

---

**13.10** SL · JAMIE · settings2 — *(next phrase)*

He opens Settings → Battery. 9%, Low Power Mode, and the usage table that says where the night went.

**ON SCREEN**

**SETTINGS** – Settings > Battery

**gauge:** 9% · Last charged yesterday, 11:41 PM

· Low Power Mode – ON

· Messages – 6 hr 12 min (top conversation: R.H. EDITS)

· Safari – 1 hr 03 min

**PLAYS**

UNLOCK — the lock slides up and away → home screen · sound: unlock swish

OPENS Settings — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

**SOUND**

unlock swish

PHONES SL = settings2 · stamp “JUNE 2026 · BEFORE DAWN” · clock 7:58

---

**13.11** SL · JAMIE · Messages — *FINAL SECTION*

Back to Messages — a new, empty conversation. To: |

**PLAYS**

OPENS Messages — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES SL = Messages · stamp “JUNE 2026 · BEFORE DAWN” · clock 7:58

---

**13.12** SL · JAMIE · Messages — *(his last sung phrase)*

He types “hey” to someone new.

**ON SCREEN**

**TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed):** “hey”

**PLAYS**

sound: key clicks

**SOUND**

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

---

**13.13** SL · JAMIE · Messages — *(as the phrase ends)*

And deletes even that.

**ON SCREEN**

**BACKSPACES** the draft to nothing (fast rattle)

**PLAYS**

sound: backspace rattle

**SOUND**

rapid delete clicks

---

**13.14** SL · JAMIE · note — *In the silence before the final chord*

Notes. A note called “we need to talk,” edited eleven weeks ago, one line long. He has been carrying the ending since before the fight.

**ON SCREEN**

**NOTES** — “we need to talk” · Edited March 24 — 11 weeks ago

cathy —

I don’t know how to start this, so I’ll just say it.

**PLAYS**

OPENS Notes — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES SL = note · stamp “JUNE 2026 · BEFORE DAWN” · clock 7:58

**HOLD** · *The last screen of the song. Let it land alone.*

---

# 14 · Goodbye Until Tomorrow / I Could Never Rescue You **BOTH**

**SING · 12 FIRES**

THE GRAMMAR RESOLVES. Her firsts fill as his lasts empty — the same thread from both ends, five years apart.

## 14.1 **BOTH · CATHY · Lock screen** — *THE DUET BEGINS* — *first vocal entrance*

HER phone. September 2021, 11:58 PM. The night they met.

**ON SCREEN**

**STAMP** → “SEPTEMBER 2021 · THE FIRST NIGHT”

**LOCK CLOCK** — 11:58 · Friday, September 3, 2021

**PLAYS**

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY’s screen

PHONES **BOTH** = Lock screen · stamp “SEPTEMBER 2021 · THE FIRST NIGHT” · clock 11:58

## 14.2 **BOTH · CATHY · contact** — *CATHY: Goodbye until tomorrow* —

She saves his number on a real contact card — then edits it, and adds a sparkle.

**ON SCREEN**

**CONTACT CARD** — Jamie ✨ · Added just now

**name mid-edit**: “Jamie Wellerstein” struck through → “Jamie ✨” typed in

**PLAYS**

**UNLOCK** — the lock slides up and away → home screen · sound: unlock swish

**OPENS Messages** — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

**SOUND**

unlock swish

PHONES **BOTH** = contact · stamp “SEPTEMBER 2021 · THE FIRST NIGHT” · clock 11:58

## 14.3 **BOTH · CATHY · Messages** — *CATHY: Goodbye until I crawl to your door* —

His text is already waiting: “home safe?”

**ON SCREEN**

**THREAD HISTORY** — loads whole with the thread:

— Today · 11:48 PM

**RECEIVED (gray)**: “home safe?”

**PLAYS**

cut to Messages (instant)

PHONES **BOTH** = Messages · stamp “SEPTEMBER 2021 · THE FIRST NIGHT” · clock 11:58

## 14.4 **BOTH · CATHY · Messages** — *CATHY: “I have been waiting for you!”*

She starts her reply. SHE IS STILL TYPING WHEN THE SHOW ENDS.

**ON SCREEN**

**TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed)**: “safe 😊 tonight was”

**PLAYS**

sound: key clicks

**SOUND**

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

**HOLD** · *Do not send. This is the payoff of Shiksa Goddess, two hours ago.*

**14.5 BOTH · JAMIE · Mail** — *JAMIE: I could never rescue you* —

FLIP TO HIS SCREEN. June 2026, 2:40 PM. His inbox is the same three emails she will read on Friday — the sender's side.

**ON SCREEN**

**STAMP** → "JUNE 2026 · HIS LAST AFTERNOON"

**LOCK CLOCK** — 2:40 · Friday, June 12, 2026

**INBOX** — loads whole, the instant the app opens:

- U-MOVE • — Booking confirmed — Saturday 8:00 AM — 1 bedroom · pickup W 73rd St (2:31 PM)
- Chase — Account closed — joint checking — Confirmation of closure. Funds transferred. (1:55 PM)
- Kessler & Roth LLP — Following our call — Attached, as discussed. Please review at your convenience. (2:50 PM)

**PLAYS**

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE's screen

cut to Mail (instant)

no animation — a real inbox does not populate; it is simply THERE, continuing past the bottom edge

PHONES BOTH = Mail · stamp "JUNE 2026 · HIS LAST AFTERNOON" · clock 2:40

**14.6 BOTH · JAMIE · Mail** — *JAMIE: "I went downtown and closed the bank account"*

His SENT folder. "Some practical things," 4:12 PM, To: Cathy — the email the house read from her side in Still Hurting. THE JOINT ACCOUNT FROM MOVING TOO FAST, CLOSED.

**ON SCREEN**

**SENT** — loads whole, the instant the app opens:

- To: Cathy — Some practical things — Cathy — I didn't want to do this over the phone. I went... (4:12 PM)
- To: Kessler & Roth LLP — Re: Following our call — Understood. Go ahead. (3:05 PM)
- To: U-MOVE — Booking — Saturday — Confirmed for 8 AM. One bedroom. (2:12 PM)

**PLAYS**

no animation — a real inbox does not populate; it is simply THERE, continuing past the bottom edge

**HOLD** · *The audience watched this open in Act One, and read it arrive in song one.*

**14.7 BOTH · JAMIE · music** — *JAMIE: All I could do was love you.*

He opens Music — the playlist from 2021. Leave "US"? — this button he CAN press.

**ON SCREEN**

**MUSIC** — playlist "US 🎧" · Collaborative Playlist — Jamie & Cathy

♪ (greeked track) — Added by Cathy 🧡

♪ (greeked track) — Added by you

♪ (greeked track) — Added by Cathy 🧡

**ACTION SHEET** slides up over the app — "Leave "US 🎧"? You will no longer be able to listen with Cathy."

**buttons:** [Leave Playlist] (red) · [Cancel]

**FINGER RESTS ON** [Leave Playlist] — the button holds its pressed shade. Not pressing.

**PRESSES** [Leave Playlist]

**banner over the playlist:** "You left this playlist"

**PLAYS**

OPENS Music — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES BOTH = music · stamp "JUNE 2026 · HIS LAST AFTERNOON" · clock 2:40

**14.8 BOTH · JAMIE · vm** — *JAMIE: I could never rescue you* —

The real Voicemail screen. Cathy — April 9, 2025 — 0:47, saved two years. He presses play; the transcription reads along under his final verse.

**ON SCREEN**

**VOICEMAIL** — Cathy 🍷 · April 9, 2025 · 0:47 · SAVED

**scrubber:** playing at 0:14

**transcription:** "JAMIE. CALL ME BACK. I GOT OHIO. I GOT—"

**PLAYS**

OPENS Phone — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

**SOUND**

voicemail playback: her recorded VO, 0:47

PHONES BOTH = vm · stamp "JUNE 2026 · HIS LAST AFTERNOON" · clock 2:40

**HOLD** · *The man who empties Recently Deleted keeps her happiest 47 seconds.*

**14.9 BOTH · JAMIE · vm** — *(verse button)*

Delete Voicemail? His thumb crosses to Delete — and presses Cancel. He keeps this too.

**ON SCREEN**

**ACTION SHEET** slides up over the app — "Delete this voicemail?"

**buttons:** [Delete Voicemail] (red) · [Cancel]

**FINGER RESTS ON** [Delete Voicemail] — the button holds its pressed shade. Not pressing.

**PRESSES** [Cancel]

**VOICEMAIL** — Cathy 🍷 · April 9, 2025 · 0:47 · SAVED

**scrubber:** stopped at 0:47

**transcription:** "JAMIE. CALL ME BACK. I GOT OHIO. I GOT—"

**SOUND**

voicemail playback: her recorded VO, 0:47

**14.10 BOTH · JAMIE · Messages** — *JAMIE: Goodbye.*

He opens her thread — the same messages the house read at 9:41 this morning, mirrored from his side. All read. Never answered.

**ON SCREEN**

**THREAD HISTORY** — loads whole with the thread:

— Monday · 11:02 PM

**RECEIVED (gray):** "are you coming home this weekend?"

— Wednesday · 8:15 AM

**RECEIVED (gray):** "please just call me"

— Wednesday · 9:30 PM

**RECEIVED (gray):** "I still have your ring"

— Today · 9:41 AM

**RECEIVED (gray):** "I'm not sure that I can do this without you"

— · READ 9:44 AM — he never answered

**PLAYS**

OPENS Messages — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES BOTH = Messages · stamp "JUNE 2026 · HIS LAST AFTERNOON" · clock 2:40

**HOLD** · *The image the whole night has been building to.*

**14.11 BOTH · JAMIE** — *HE puts the key on the table and goes.*

His screen dies.

**ON SCREEN**

**HOUSE BLACK** — the phone vanishes into it

**PLAYS**

hard black

**SOUND**

room tone out

**14.12 BOTH · CATHY · Messages** — *CATHY: Goodbye until tomorrow. (final)*

BACK TO HER. Five years earlier, still typing. She glows on through the final chord.

**ON SCREEN**

**STAMP** → "SEPTEMBER 2021 · THE FIRST NIGHT"

**LOCK CLOCK** — 11:58 · Friday, September 3, 2021

**THREAD HISTORY** — loads whole with the thread:

— Today · 11:48 PM

**RECEIVED (gray)**: "home safe?"

**TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed)**: "safe 😊 tonight was"

**PLAYS**

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY's screen

UNLOCK — the lock slides up and away → home screen · sound: unlock swish

OPENS Messages — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap  
sound: key clicks

**SOUND**

unlock swish

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

PHONES BOTH = Messages · stamp "SEPTEMBER 2021 · THE FIRST NIGHT" · clock 11:58

**HOLD** · *Hold it. Do not resolve it.*